

PUMLA MATOKAZI

SOFTWARE ENGINEER | DATA ENGINEERING FOCUS

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 GitHub

SUMMARY

Versatile and motivated Software Engineering student at WeThinkCode_ (NQF Level 6, graduating May 2026) with hands-on experience in full-stack development, backend systems, and data engineering pipelines. Proficient in Python, Java, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, SQL, PostgreSQL, and OOP principles. Currently specializing in Data Engineering, including ETL pipelines, relational database design, advanced SQL queries, and data ingestion, while developing and deploying applications on AWS cloud platforms.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Backend

Python (CLI tools, scripting, unittest/pytest) Java (Javalin, JDBC, OOP) JavaScript (Node.js, Express)

Databases & Data Engineering

SQL (advanced queries, joins, subqueries, indexing, optimization) PostgreSQL, relational databases, data persistence, ETL pipelines, data architecture, data ingestion, data governance

Tools & Technologies

Git, GitHub, GitLab, Linux, Postman, Jupyter Notebooks, Bash, Miro

Web Development

HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Cloud & DevOps

AWS (building and deploying applications, Lambda, S3, serverless workflows) Docker, CI/CD (GitHub Actions / GitLab CI/CD)

Methodologies

Agile, Test-Driven Development (TDD), separation of concerns, refactoring, acceptance tests, iterative development.

PROJECTS

KasiBridge, *Mobile Banking App for the Unbanked* | Python, Java, JavaScript, HTML/CSS

Mobile-friendly web app enabling deposits, withdrawals, bill payments, transaction tracking, and downloadable statements Backend: Secure transaction processing, multi-stage validation, and custom credit scoring ("Kasi Score") Data Management: Maintains balances and transaction history using Python structures and localStorage.

Mental Health Support Chatbot, *Python, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, AWS*

Chatbot enabling mood tracking, personalized coping tips, and mental health support Cloud-deployed on AWS Lambda and S3 for scalable access. Designed a simple conversational flow to simulate real-time mental health support interactions. Implemented backend logic in Python to process user input and generate context-aware responses. Implemented backend logic in Python to process user input and generate context-aware responses.

Internal Reporting Dashboard - Brownfield System Modernization (In-Progress),

Python/Java, JS/HTML/CSS, Docker, CI/CD, AWS (future deployment)

Modernized legacy reporting system into modular, maintainable architecture Developed web interface with REST APIs for real-time summaries and external integrations Preparing AWS deployment for cloud-hosted reporting.

WORK EXPERIENCE

WeThinkCode_ - Project Administrator (Volunteer)	02/2025 – Present
Coordinated project tracking, attendance, and student participation Consolidated weekly reports and maintained organized records Assisted in logistics, dashboards, and supervisor-student communication Developed administrative, organizational, and problem-solving skills using Google Workspace/Excel Communication bridge between students and supervisors.	
Tenacity Financial Services - Data Capture	10/2021 – 09/2024
Captured and verified financial data accurately and efficiently Maintained data integrity and compliance standards Improved workflow processes, reducing input errors Gained hands-on experience with relational data structures, data validation, and data management practices. Applied analytical skills to identify trends, inconsistencies, and opportunities for process improvement.	

EDUCATION

Diploma in Software Engineering (NQF Level 6), WeThinkCode_	05/2026
Project-based, peer-to-peer curriculum emphasizing full-stack development, software engineering best practices, and collaborative learning. Programming & OOP: Python & Java, unit testing, REST APIs, modular programming, encapsulation, inheritance, polymorphism, and concurrency. Engineering & Brownfields Development: Refactoring, TDD, CI/CD pipelines (Docker), SQL/PostgreSQL, ORM, design patterns, secure Git workflows, and iterative development. Distributed Systems & Cloud: API design, asynchronous programming, Domain-Driven Design, multi-team architecture, AWS deployments, with strong focus on teamwork, communication, and agile practices.	Cape Town, South Africa

SOFT SKILLS

Communication
Teamwork / Collaboration
Problem-solving
Adaptability
Time management
Leadership / Initiative
Emotional intelligence
Resilience / Growth mindset